

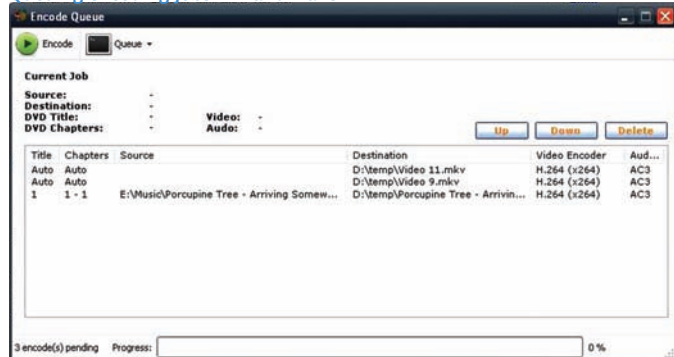


tips & tricks

settings you want, and then click the “Add to queue” button. Repeat these steps for the whole batch of videos you wish to convert.

Set level of processing power

Queuing encoding jobs in HandBrake



To speed up the encoding process, you can set the level of processing power to be used for encoding. Click on **Tools > Options** and go to the CLI tab. Here, you can select the number of processor cores you wish to use and priority level. Choosing “Below

can improve quality but excessive use can reduce image detail. So it is recommended to keep it at “Weak” for most purposes.

VBULLETIN

Every good site has its own forum. It's a common meeting place for others with similar interests to interact with. Digit readers would know that we have a huge forum — the largest technology forum in India. You can visit it at www.thinkdigit.com/forum.

Although users can view it, to be a proper participant, you must register with the forum. The Register link on the left top lets you do that. The registration is simple and takes only a minute. After that, you have complete access to years of content related to programming, hardware, games and troubleshooting of hardware and software problems. There are sections even for educational and career planning.

Every forum runs on software, such as PhpBB. The software used by Digit is vBulletin, also used by many other communities on the internet. A service such as vBulletin has many features that users would typically ignore. Some of these features are useful for finding the right content, to keep you updated, while some of them are meant to make posting simple and quick. Some other features are for cosmetic purposes only.

Viewing active posts

The Digit Forum is a very active place. There are hundreds of posts made every few hours and it's very difficult to keep track of every single thread and post. To

What makes Handbrake so good is that it is constantly developed, with over 600 changes from the previous version.

keep track of it, one of the simplest ways is to use the New Posts link on the top of the page in the centre. This feature simply lists all the posts that were made after you last logged in. This is a much more effective way to find new posts than going through each and every section.

Social groups

All the users on a forum have a common interest; but within every single interest, there's always a niche topic. Members with these common interests can create social groups — something similar to the way in which Facebook works. Separate subsections in the forum can be set up, so users in particular social groups are given permissions to view and post.

Social groups can be accessed by clicking on **Quick Links > Social Groups**. You can also search for created groups in the text box on the top-right corner of the page. Once you click on the social group, you can see the posts made on that group. Click on the Join group link to join that group.

Subscribing to threads

If there are threads that interest you, then you can subscribe to them. Accessing these threads is simple from there on. You can also receive updates on the status of the thread. For example, if somebody posts a reply on the thread, you can receive a mail notification.

First, open the thread to which you want to subscribe, then click on **Thread Tools** and click on **Subscribe** to this Thread in the dropdown. You can choose the kind of notification by clicking on the first dropdown menu. Choose instant notification if you want a real-time alert of additions made to a thread. If you visit a forum once a day, then you can opt for the daily notification. If any time you want to unsubscribe, click on **Quick Links > Subscribed threads**. Click on the checkboxes of the threads you want to unsubscribe. Then, click on **Actions** dropdown menu on the bottom right. Choose **Delete Subscription** and click on **Go**.

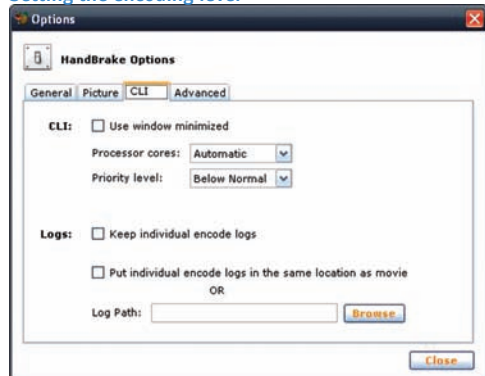
Disabling automatic subscriptions

Every thread you reply to automatically gets added to your subscription list. This can be disabled by first going to **User CP** and then to **Edit Options**. Scroll down to the **Messaging & Notification** section. Click the dropdown menu for **Default Thread Subscription Mode** and choose **Do not Subscribe**. Click on **Save Changes** button at the bottom of the page.

Linking to a single post

There are plenty of interesting threads on the forum and quite frequently you may want to share a gem with your friends or colleagues. It could be a set of links to others sites or a few wallpapers. Copying thread URLs is really simple but that

Setting the encoding level



Normal” will allow you to run other applications and use your system while encoding, while “High” will allot more processing power to encoding.

Picture settings

The Picture Settings tab has several settings that can be customised. These are Cropping, Size and Filter settings. Cropping allows you to remove the black lines that some movies have on the sides. HandBrake does this automatically, but sometimes it doesn't catch everything. In such a case, clicking the “Custom” radio button will allow you to do it manually. Under Size, anamorphic settings will allow you to change the output resolution. Select loose or none to be able to specify it manually. Of the filters, “Denoise” is one that can be used safely in most cases. Denoising simply removes excess graininess from the video. This

Crop, resize and apply filters in the Picture Settings Tab

